RONNIE CLELAND

CREATIVE AI PLATFORM ARCHITECT

Artist-facing products / Generative media / Production systems

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PROFILE

Creative AI platform architect and visual-production leader with **20+ years** across feature animation, VFX, real-time look development, and artist tools. Co-founder of Lumify AI, connecting artistic judgment with hands-on product design and full-stack implementation. Builds creative systems that make intent, review, and the next decision visible.

CURRENT EXPERIENCE

LUMIFY AI 2024 - Present

Co-Founder & Chief Creative Technology Officer

- Lead product strategy, creative direction, and interaction design for a browser-based platform spanning image, video, and 3D/world workflows.
- Build responsive HTML/CSS/JavaScript interfaces and Python/Flask services for model integration, server-controlled provider routing, asynchronous jobs, and result registration.
- Connect the creative canvas with saved projects, reference libraries, shot direction, and the Cut; retain earlier takes and separate preview from explicit selection for the edit.
- Implement generation quote review and explicit approval, job status and recovery, source lineage, saved revisions, and approved cost estimates.
- Integrate Runway, fal.ai, World Labs, and local model services through capability-aware controls and deployment policies.

SELECTED PRODUCT SYSTEMS

DIRECTED CREATION Reference approval and Library lock; relighting, material, time-of-day, and saved camera direction; reviewed batch still and shot-video workflows.

REVIEW TO CUT Retained takes, source history, explicit Use in Cut, shot timing, and review MP4 assembly; speech, music, and sound workflows.

PRODUCTION CONTINUITY Project persistence, revision protection, provider provenance, generation history, metadata, and traceable handoff.

TECHNICAL PRACTICE

Build: JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Python, Flask, REST APIs, SQLite, FFmpeg.
Integrate: Hosted and local inference, model/provider adapters, AI Toolkit; working knowledge of PyTorch/CUDA, Diffusers, Transformers, and ComfyUI.

THE PRODUCTION FOUNDATION

20+ years of craft, creative leadership, and visual problem-solving.

SELECTED PRIOR EXPERIENCE

FABLELIGHT STUDIOS
2023 - 2024

Digital Innovation

Explored next-generation stories and workflows with artists, connecting emerging technology and storytelling.

SPIRE ANIMATION
2021 - 2023

Unreal Look Development Designer

Developed worlds and concepts for *Trouble* with a previs team using Unreal Engine and Substance, combining real-time world building, material design, and look development.

DREAMWORKS ANIMATION
2010 - 2021

Department Chair / Look Development Supervisor / Environment Surfacing Lead

Led and collaborated across feature-animation world building, surfacing, look development, and shot quality. Translated creative direction into environments, materials, reviews, and pipeline-ready deliverables while balancing visual ambition, schedule, and evolving story needs.

Selected productions: The Croods 2, How to Train Your Dragon 3, Trolls Holiday Special, Boss Baby, Kung Fu Panda 3, Penguins, Home, The Croods, and Puss in Boots.

RHYTHM & HUES
2008 - 2009

Texture TD

Primary texture artist on Land of the Lost, Night at the Museum 2, and Cirque du Freak.

ASYLUM VFX
2008 - 2010

Texture Artist

Texture work on The Curious Case of Benjamin Button, The Sorcerer's Apprentice, Prince of Persia, and commercials.

GENTLE GIANT
2007 - 2008

Next-Generation Character Development

Digital art and character/creature workflows for scans, feature films, next-generation releases, and toy products.

LOOK FX
2006

Matte Painter & Roto Artist

Rotoscope work on Pirates of the Caribbean 2, Rocky Balboa, and The Nightmare Before Christmas; matte painting for a NASA simulation ride.

SONY PICTURES IMAGEWORKS
2005

Dust-Busting Roto Artist

Dust-busting work on Ghost Rider; internal Maya and production training.

EDUCATION

Gnomon - Certificate of Visual FX, Hollywood, CA
Delgado - Visual Communications, New Orleans, LA
USC - Media Arts, Columbia, SC